WEEKEND TRUCKER

MEMBERS PACK

Load Orders Explained

The simple start-here guide to getting your mods loading in the right order

Euro Truck Simulator 2 • American Truck Simulator

1. What Is a Load Order?

When you activate mods in the game's Mod Manager, they don't all get treated equally. The game reads them in a specific order, the order you see in the list. That list is your load order.

Here's the one rule everything else in this guide is built on: **the mod at the TOP of the list always wins.**

If two mods change the same thing, say, two mods both change the weather, the game uses the version from whichever mod sits higher in the list. The mod lower down gets overruled for anything they both touch.

Think of it like a stack of stickers

Imagine each mod is a sticker, and you're stacking them on top of each other. Where two stickers overlap, you only see the one on top. Where they don't overlap, you see both. That's exactly how mods work: the top mod's changes always show through, and lower mods fill in everything the ones above didn't touch.

> **TIP:** “Higher priority” just means “higher in the list.” Top = strongest. Bottom = weakest. That's it.

2. Why Does It Matter?

Most of the time, mods don't overlap at all. A paint job and a sound mod change completely different things, so their order barely matters. But when mods DO overlap, the order decides three things:

- **What you actually see in game.** Wrong order and your shiny new graphics mod can be silently overruled by something above it, it's “working”, you just can't see it.
- **Whether fixes and patches do their job.** A patch must sit ABOVE the thing it patches, or the original wins and the patch does nothing.
- **Whether the game crashes.** Big map mods define roads, cities and companies. If two maps fight over the same piece of the world in the wrong order, the game can fail to load or crash mid-drive.

So a load order isn't about being tidy, it's about making sure every mod you installed actually does what you paid attention to it for, and that the big ones don't take the game down.

3. The Basic Shape of a Good Load Order

You don't need to memorise the perfect position of every mod. You just need to put each mod into the right SECTION, from top to bottom. Here's the shape that works, with the strongest stuff at the top and the big heavy maps at the bottom:

TOP OF THE LIST — highest priority, always wins

Map screen & background map tweaks *full-screen map, map zoom, background maps*
Loading screens
Graphics & weather *one weather mod only — see Section 5*
Sound
Physics
Interface & other small tweaks
Tuning & interiors
AI traffic
Cargo
Paint jobs & skins
Trailers
Trucks
MAPS *the big map mods — always the bottom block*

BOTTOM OF THE LIST — lowest priority, the foundation

Why maps at the bottom? Maps are the foundation everything else sits on. Keeping them at the bottom means every fix, patch and tweak above them can overrule the bits it needs to — which is exactly what you want.

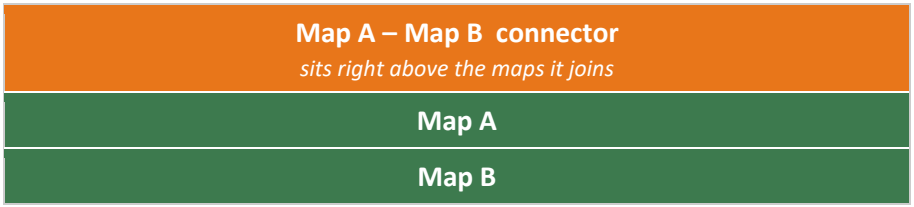
> **TIP:** Don't stress about perfection inside a section. Two paint jobs swapping places will never crash your game. It's the MAPS block where order really counts.

4. The Maps Section — Where Order Really Counts

If you only run trucks, skins and sounds, you can relax. But the moment you run more than one map mod, the maps block at the bottom of your list has rules of its own. Three of them cover almost everything:

Rule 1 — Patches and connectors go DIRECTLY ABOVE the map they fix

A “connector” (sometimes called an RC or road connection) is a small mod that joins two map mods together. A “fix” patches problems between maps. Both only work if they sit above the map they're fixing — and the safest habit is to put each one immediately above its map, not in a pile at the top.



Rule 2 — Multi-part maps stay together, in the author's order

Big maps often come as several files: a definitions file, a map file, and one or more asset or model packs. Keep the whole family together as one block, in the exact order the map's author says (it's on their download page or in the readme). Part 1 above Part 2, Part 2 above Part 3, and so on.

Rule 3 — If a fix's map isn't installed, remove the fix

A connector or patch for a map you don't actually have isn't harmless, the game can flag it as incompatible or it can cause errors on its own. If you removed a map, remove its fixes and connectors too.

> **TIP:** Map authors almost always publish their recommended order. When the author tells you an order, that beats any general rule in this guide, they built it, they know.

5. The “Pick One” Rule

Some types of mod are like drivers fighting over one steering wheel, only one can be in charge. Running two at once doesn't give you both; it gives you glitches or crashes. Pick your favourite and deactivate the rest:

Pick ONE of these	Why
Weather / climate mods	They all rewrite the same weather system. Two at once = broken skies, flickering, or crashes.
Full graphics overhaul suites	Each suite expects to control the whole graphics pipeline. Mixing suites breaks both.
Physics mods	Two sets of physics rules fighting = a truck that handles like a shopping trolley.
Economy / money starter mods	They rewrite the same economy numbers — the game only keeps one anyway.
Two versions of the SAME mod	An old v1.2 next to a new v1.3 makes the game load the same content twice. Delete the old one.

The exception: add-ons made FOR your chosen mod. A seasons add-on made for your weather mod, or a lighting add-on made for your graphics suite, is fine, it goes just above the thing it adds to (add-on above base, always).

6. Common Mistakes (and the Fix)

The mistake	The fix
Dumping every new mod at the top of the list	New mods go into their section (use the table in Section 3), not the top.
A patch or connector sitting BELOW the map it fixes	Move it directly above that map. Below = the patch does nothing.
Map parts scattered around the list	Keep a multi-part map together as one block, in the author's numbered order.
Running fixes for maps you've removed	Removed the map? Remove its fixes and connectors in the same session.
Two weather or graphics overhauls at once	Pick one, deactivate the rest (Section 5).
Changing ten things at once, then it crashes	Change one thing at a time and test. When it breaks, you'll know exactly what broke it.
Editing your mod list while the game is running	Always fully close the game first, it saves over your changes when it exits.

7. When Something Goes Wrong

Game crashing or acting weird after a mod change? Work through this, in order:

- **Think about what changed last.** The most recent mod you added, updated or moved is the prime suspect. Deactivate it and test.
- **Check the game's own verdict.** In your Documents folder, inside the game's folder, there's a file called game.log.txt. Open it in Notepad and search for the word “incompatible” the game literally names mods it refused to load.
- **Halve it.** Still stuck? Deactivate the bottom half of your mods and test. Works now? The problem's in that half. Keep halving until you've cornered the one mod causing it. Slow but bulletproof.
- **Check for updates.** After a game update, some mods need updating too, especially maps, dashboards and graphics mods. An out of date mod that worked last month can crash today.

> **TIP:** Deactivating a mod never deletes it, and it never deletes your save. You can always switch it back on. Test bravely.

8. The 60-Second Checklist

Before you hit Drive, run down this list:

- **Maps at the bottom** — every big map mod lives in the bottom block of the list.
- **Patches above their maps** — every connector and fix sits directly above the map it belongs to.
- **Map families together** — multi-part maps in one block, in the author's order.
- **One weather, one graphics suite, one physics mod** — no fighting over the steering wheel.
- **No orphan fixes** — no patches for maps you've removed.
- **No duplicate versions** — old versions of updated mods deleted.
- **Game fully closed** — before making any mod list changes.
- **One change at a time** — when you're testing something new.

That's the whole game.

Top wins. Maps at the bottom. Patches above their maps. Pick one of anything that fights.

Weekend Trucker